outlet not available to most—commercial writing.

As research steadily lost its glamor for me, writing grew steadily more attractive. And as writing grew steadily more attractive, research steadily lost its glamor. Either tendency reinforced the other in a spiral that made me, with each month that passed, more of a writer and less of a researcher.

It was no wonder, then, that once we were through with the writing of the textbook, I did not go back to a fuller concern for research. I did not even want to. There was still work to be done with the textbook, and if that failed I had other projects that could be done on school time. There was the biochemistry-for-the-layman book I was doing for little, Brown. It might be for the layman, but it was still a scholarly book, and I still felt it ethical to do it on school time, leaving my nonschool time for fiction.

The formal signing of the contract with Little, Brown came on February 7, 1952. Almost immediately afterward they sent me a $250 advance and I decided to call the book The Puzzle of Life. I felt myself finally to be in the business of writing nonfiction by myself.

Fiction remained alive, too. Unexpectedly, Fantasy and Science Fiction accepted "King Lear VI, 1, 36" and I was delighted. I had been reading F 6> SF since its inception and I had felt that its level of writing was distinctly above my own capacities. Its stories were more "literary" than mine ever were.

I had once thought the same of Unknown, and just as I had then longed to sell to Unknown, I now longed to sell to F & SF— and feared I never would.

But I had, and all Tony Boucher asked me to do was to change the title. Nowadays, offbeat titles are very common, but in those days they weren't. I changed the title to "Flies" and, actually, I thought it an im-improvement.

3

We finished work on the galleys of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism on February 20, 1952. On March 10, the page proofs started coming in and that meant indexing.

We decided that each one of us would index our own chapters. I had never indexed anything before, but I had a vague idea as to how it should be done. My philosophy was that any reader, using the index, should be able to find every mention of every topic of biochemical interest. I made an enormous pile